

ADUs may do little for housing

Backyard units are booming. Here’s why that’s not enough to ease the state’s crisis.

By Terry Castleman

With California facing a critical housing shortage, accessory dwelling units now account for a significant portion of the state’s meager growth in new homes, data reviewed by The Times show.

California has struggled to keep up with demand, increasing housing stock by only 0.84% in 2024, or 125,000 units. ADUs made up about one-fifth of those units, according to California Department of Finance data.

ADU construction has been booming in some parts of California, with homeowners taking advantage of the opportunity to build a second housing unit in their backyard. The units often cost hundreds of thousands of dollars, but many residents see them as worthy investments that increase property value.

But ADUs are different from new apartments and homes. Some ADU owners do not put their units on the market, using them instead for their own families or leaving them vacant. And ADUs are more popular in some areas than others.

Eric McGhee, a senior fellow at the Public Policy Institute of California, said it’s hard to know whether new ADUs are being used to house people who wouldn’t otherwise be on the property, or whether they are just providing extra space for those already living there. As a result, it is likely that some ADUs do nothing to ease the housing shortage.

One clue comes from the San Diego Assn. of Governments, which calculated that 85% of permitted ADUs in the county were occupied by renters, with only 15% occupied by owners.

Still, in many cases, ADUs might be occupied by people spreading out within a property they already occupy, McGhee said, complicating analysis of the impact on the broader housing market.

“Is it enough to just build [See Housing, A6]



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KEVIN DIETSCH Getty Images

MEMBERS of the U.S. Park Police, top, patrol Monday along the National Mall. Above, demonstrators protest the federal takeover of the Washington police force.

Trump sending federal troops to control D.C.

Saying ‘bloodthirsty criminals’ have taken over the city, he uses same tactics as in L.A.

By Jenny Jarvie, Michael Wilner and Sonja Sharp

WASHINGTON — In an expansion of tactics started in June during immigration raids in Los Angeles, President Trump on Monday announced he would take federal control of Washington’s police department and activate 800 National Guard troops in the nation’s capital to help “reestablish law and order.”

“Our capital city has been overtaken by violent gangs and bloodthirsty criminals, roving mobs of wild youth, drugged-out maniacs and homeless people,” Trump said at the White House.

“This is liberation day in D.C.,” he declared.

Trump, who sent roughly 5,000 Marines and National Guard troops to L.A. in June in a move that was opposed by California Gov. Gavin Newsom and L.A. Mayor Karen Bass, issued an executive order declaring a public safety emergency in D.C. The order invoked Section

740 of the District of Columbia Home Rule Act that places the Metropolitan Police Department under direct federal control.

The California governor decried Trump’s move in D.C., warning that what happened in L.A. was now taking place across the country.

“He was just getting warmed up in Los Angeles,” Newsom said on X. “He will gaslight his way into militarizing any city he wants in America. This is what dictators do.”

In his briefing, Trump painted D.C. in dark, apocalyptic terms as a grimy hell-hole “of crime, bloodshed, bedlam, squalor and worse.” He said he planned to get tough, citing his administration’s stringent enforcement on the nation’s southern border.

Already, Trump said, his administration has begun to remove homeless people from encampments across the city, and he said he planned to target undocumented immigrants, too. He vowed to “restore the city back to the gleaming capital that everybody wants it to be.”

As the White House noted in a fact sheet Monday, D.C. had a 2024 homicide rate of 10.1 per 100,000 residents, the highest in the nation. [See Troops, A8]

Surprise: No two ‘Big Ones’ alike

What could the next mega-earthquake on California’s notorious San Andreas fault look like?

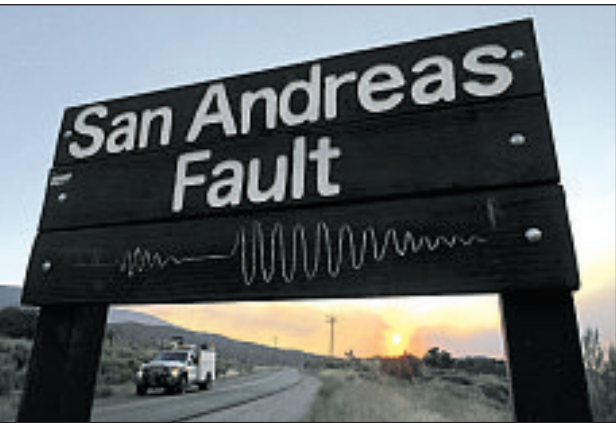
Would it be a repeat of 1857, when an earthquake estimated at magnitude 7.7 to 7.9 ruptured the fault from Monterey County all the way through Los Angeles County? Would it be more akin to the great 1906 San Francisco earthquake, which began just offshore of the city and ruptured in two directions, toward Humboldt County and Santa Cruz County?

Don’t bet on an identical sequel.

That’s the implication of a study published Monday in the journal Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences. The report, co-authored by scientists at Caltech in Pasadena, studied a

Can Myanmar quake offer clues to San Andreas fault? Don’t bet on it.

By Rong-Gong Lin II



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

EXPERTS say the San Andreas fault could rupture in San Bernardino, Riverside and Imperial counties.

massive earthquake that ruptured in Myanmar on March 28 — on a fault known for being eerily similar to the San Andreas.

The earthquake in Southeast Asia ended up rupturing a much longer section of the fault than scientists expected, given the seismology of the region.

The implications of this study are that “earthquakes never come back exactly the same way,” Solene L. Antoine, a postdoctoral fellow at Caltech and the study’s lead author, said in an interview.

“It came as a surprise that you could get such a long rupture,” said Jean-Philippe Avouac, a co-author of the study and a professor of geology and mechanical and civil engineering at Caltech. [See Quake, A14]

Congress questions plans for ICE cash

The infusion of new funding from the GOP’s big spending bill sets off alarms.

By Lisa Mascaro

WASHINGTON — President Trump’s border advisor Tom Homan visited Capitol Hill just weeks after Inauguration Day, with other administration officials and a singular message: They needed money for the White House’s border security and mass deportation agenda.

By summer, Congress delivered. The Republican Party’s big bill of tax breaks and spending cuts that Trump signed into law July 4 included what’s arguably the biggest boost of funds yet to the Department of Homeland Security — nearly \$170 billion, almost double its annual budget.

Now the crush of new money is setting off alarms in Congress and beyond, raising questions from Democratic and Republican lawmakers who are expected to provide oversight. The bill text provided general funding categories — almost \$30 billion for ICE officers, \$45 billion for detention facilities, \$10 billion for the office of Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem — but few policy details or directives.

The staggering cash infusion is powering the nation’s sweeping Immigration and Customs Enforcement operations, delivering gripping scenes of people being pulled off city streets and from job sites across the nation — the cornerstone of Trump’s promise for the largest domestic deportation operation in American history.

Homeland Security confirmed over the weekend that ICE is working to set up detention sites at certain military bases.

“We’re getting them out at record numbers,” Trump said at the White House bill signing ceremony. “We have an obligation to, and we’re [See Funding, A8]



Al Jazeera

ANAS al-Sharif, 28, of Al Jazeera and five other journalists were killed Sunday.

Journalist slain in Israeli strike was a voice in war-torn Gaza

By Nabil Bulos

AMMAN, Jordan — Israel’s military targeted a tent for journalists in Gaza City late Sunday, killing seven people, including Anas al-Sharif, a reporter for Al Jazeera, who drew millions of followers on social media and emerged as a top voice in the Arab world for his chronicling of the war in Gaza over the last 22

months.

Killed alongside the 28-year-old Al-Sharif were Al Jazeera correspondent Mohammed Qreiqh and camera operators Ibrahim Zaher, Moamen Aliwa and their assistant Mohammed Noufal. A sixth journalist, freelancer Mohammad al-Khaldi, who was in a nearby tent, was also killed, according to the Committee to Protect Journalists.

In a statement, Al Ja-

zeera, which is funded by the government of Qatar and has long had a fraught relationship with the Israeli government, described the killings as a “targeted assassination” that was “yet another blatant and premeditated attack on press freedom.”

“The order to assassinate Anas al-Sharif, one of Gaza’s bravest journalists, and his colleagues, is a desperate at-

[See Al Jazeera, A4]

Rats! State’s almond orchards are infested

By Summer Lin and Nathan Solis

Almond growers across Central California say they are battling a surging rat infestation across more than 100,000 acres of orchards, resulting in economic hardship and damage.

Across Fresno, Merced, Kings and Kern counties, almond farmers have reported an increase in rodent populations as the animals use irrigation canals and other waterways to spread across agricultural fields and orchards, according to a newsletter from the Almond

Board of California.

The effect could be significant as California is home to 80% of the world’s almond production. The Golden State’s almonds were once the top export to China but retaliatory tariffs have resulted in China looking for almonds from other nations instead.

The newsletter doesn’t say what kind of effect the infestation could have on almond prices for consumers in California or the U.S.

Roof rats usually spend their lives above ground but have been burrowing under almond and other nut trees [See Rats, A14]

Deadly U.S. Steel plant explosions

Blasts at a massive facility near Pittsburgh leave one dead, one missing and at least 10 injured. **NATION, A5**

Tourism wage battle heats up

L.A. sees dueling ballot measures as business and labor seek the upper hand. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Clearing.
L.A. Basin: 85/65. **B6**

Markets **A12**
Opinion Voices **A13**

Paramount deal packs a punch

The company will pay \$7.7 billion for TV and streaming rights to UFC events. **BUSINESS, A10**

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